

Russell Dudek

Growth-Stage Operations Leader | Systems Builder | Cross-Functional Operator

Pittsburgh, Pennsylvania
russelldudek.github.io/Bravo/
Target: Director of Operations |
Bravo CPG

Operator-technologist who makes complex work visible, connects technical and business teams, and builds operating mechanisms that turn messy execution into adopted, measurable outcomes. Experience spans growth-stage operations, production, purchasing, quality, customer-facing support, ERP/workflow modernization, logistics, manufacturing, and high-velocity fulfillment. Brings executive credibility without losing tactical willingness.

CLIENT ENGAGEMENT LEADERSHIP

PRODUCTION & SUPPLY FLOW

DEMAND/SUPPLY CADENCE

LOGISTICS & FULFILLMENT

ERP / WORKFLOW INTEGRATION

QUALITY SYSTEMS

CONTINUOUS IMPROVEMENT

TEAM DEVELOPMENT

DATA-TO-DECISION SYSTEMS

ROLE-ALIGNED EXPERIENCE

Director of Operations

2025-Present

Vape-Jet

- Leads AI-first operating transformation across production, purchasing, quality, customer success, support, engineering issue flow, ERP/Odoo, Jira, HubSpot, Slack, telemetry, and AI-assisted workflows.
- Connects factory, field, customer, and machine-fleet signals into prioritized work, earlier risk detection, cleaner handoffs, dashboards, standard work, training, and accountability.
- Works in a software-enabled robotics and machine-vision environment with approximately 1,000 fielded robots informing support and operating feedback loops.

Operations Management / Site Leader

2014-2018

Amazon

- Led launch and execution for Amazon Prime Pittsburgh in a 24/7 customer-backward operating environment supporting approximately five million second-day orders annually.
- Built leadership routines, labor planning, throughput visibility, escalation paths, standard work, and operating mechanisms.
- Applied Lean and Gemba practices across safety, quality, throughput, customer experience, and team engagement.
- Contributed to logistics innovation through Prime Air research and Amazon Flex geolocation concepts.

Director of Operations and Engineering Management

2000-2013

Compunetics

- Progressed through R&D program management, production management, strategic acquisition, operations management, and director-level leadership.
- Led engineering, manufacturing, quality, customer delivery, and complex technical programs in advanced electronics and high-reliability environments.
- Built quality systems, standard work, root-cause practices, performance measures, and process controls.
- Collaborated with high-consequence customers and partners including DoD, CERN, Intel, and AMD.
- Published industry articles, delivered technical talks, and participated in the HyperTransport Consortium.

Regional Director

2021-2023

Cardinal Building Products

- Built the company's first remote regional operation.
- Modernized distributed customer, CRM, commercial, fulfillment, logistics, digital marketing, SEO, and online-buying workflows.
- Advanced AI-enhanced transportation-management and route-planning concepts.

OPERATING IDENTITY

Enter the system. Make the work visible.
Reduce surprise. Build the mechanism.
Transfer the capability.

BRavo MANDATE FIT

- Lead complex engagements with executive presence and tactical credibility.
- Connect operations, sales, finance-adjacent economics, quality, engineering, and external partners.
- Create order from incomplete data, competing priorities, and unclear ownership.
- Translate analysis into operating cadence, decisions, and accountable follow-through.
- Coach teams while remaining willing to execute the unglamorous work.

CLIENT-RELEVANT MECHANISMS

- Exception and escalation cadence
- Labor, throughput, and constraint visibility
- Standard work and root-cause systems
- ERP/workflow integration and data definitions
- Partner, customer, and internal handoffs
- Training, coaching, and accountability

METHODS & TOOLS

Lean | Gemba | Six Sigma | Root cause | Standard work | KPI systems | ERP/Odoo workflows | Jira | Confluence | HubSpot | Slack | Tableau | Python | SQL | JavaScript | Agentic AI | RAG patterns | Human-in-the-loop design

CREDENTIALS

IBM Enterprise Design Thinking Practitioner
Six Sigma Certification
OSHA 10

ADDITIONAL LEADERSHIP EXPERIENCE

Founder / AI and Automation Advisor DudeWorth

2017-Present

- Develops AI-readiness and opportunity frameworks that assess value, feasibility, data readiness, governance, adoption burden, reuse, and time-to-value.
- Designs agentic workflow patterns using structured context, retrieval, AI agents, human judgment, escalation, decision records, evaluation, and governance rails.
- Advises on AI-enabled operations, logistics technology, warehouse automation, AMRs, ASRS, cobots, transportation systems, network analysis, and workflow design.
- Develops Core and DudexOS concepts as agentic operating models.

Chief Pilot, Autonomous Systems and Aerial Data Operations ZeusVu

2018-2022

- Led regulated drone operations across medical, energy, logistics, real-estate, and restricted-airspace contexts with a 100% safety record and no FAA incidents.
- Developed TensorFlow-based concepts for automated aerial inventory and computer-vision-enabled field intelligence.
- Designed medical drone delivery and chain-of-custody concepts connecting technology, risk, stakeholders, and governed execution.

Chairman of the Board Enviro Social Capital

2014-2017

- Co-founded and led a public-private impact initiative focused on sustainable infrastructure, green finance, and civic transformation.
- Helped shape and evaluate a \$200 million Social Impact Bond feasibility concept for Pittsburgh sewage and green-infrastructure improvement.

CMPT and EDS Pittsburgh Chapter Chair IEEE

2012-2016

- Led regional technology programming connecting industry, academia, STEM outreach, electronics, manufacturing, and emerging technology.
- Organized conferences, seminars, business tours, and technical programming.

TRANSFERABILITY MAP

BRAVO NEED	VERIFIED EVIDENCE THREAD
Growth-stage operating ownership	Vape-Jet: production, purchasing, quality, customer-facing functions, support, systems, telemetry, and accountability.
Demand, flow, and execution cadence	Amazon: labor planning, throughput visibility, escalation, standard work, and customer-backward operations.
Manufacturing and quality consequence	Compunetics: engineering, manufacturing, quality systems, customer delivery, root cause, and process controls.
Distributed logistics and commercial handoffs	Cardinal: remote operation, CRM, fulfillment, logistics, commercial, and customer workflows.
Structured advisory and workflow design	DudeWorth: value/feasibility frameworks, decision records, governance rails, and human-in-the-loop patterns.

LEADERSHIP THROUGH-LINE

Russell's career repeatedly sits at boundaries: technical and commercial, factory and field, strategy and daily execution, centralized systems and distributed teams. The recurring work is to make the system visible enough for people to decide and act sooner.

EDUCATION

University of Pittsburgh Bachelor of Science

Academic grounding includes materials science, physical chemistry, and biology-related studies.

HONEST CPG RAMP

Not a traditional CPG career. The specific learning obligation is retailer routing and chargeback mechanics, category-specific forecasting, co-man/co-packer economics, shelf-life and MOQ dynamics, and Bravo's own playbooks. This is a ramp requirement, not invented experience.

CLIENT OPS RUNBOOK

1. Read the system
2. Stabilize the flow
3. Build the mechanism
4. Transfer the capability

Candidate hypothesis for discussion; not presented as Bravo's internal method.

EVIDENCE INTEGRITY

Titles, dates, named partners, metrics, credentials, and technology exposure follow the private RoleForge candidate evidence record. Concepts remain labeled as concepts; contributed work remains labeled as contributed.

CANDIDATE VISION

See the complete Bravo CPG thesis, 90-day entry plan, hard-objection analysis, executive questions, and engagement portfolio simulator at russelldudek.github.io/Bravo/.